



Hot Skills

Hot Skills is a curated series designed to spotlight trending and critical skills that support career growth and future readiness. Each edition features a selection of skills accompanied by a clear rationale — framing each as a timely learning opportunity. Whether you're planning to develop in your existing career or learn a new skill, Hot Skills offers a quick, insightful way to help you stay one step ahead in your professional journey.

In this edition: Stakeholder Management

**Identifying & Mapping Stakeholders | Building Trust & Relationships |
Influencing Without Authority | Managing Expectations & Communication**

01 Identifying & Mapping Stakeholders

Why is identifying and mapping stakeholders critical for delivering successful outcomes?

Research shows that projects are significantly more likely to succeed when stakeholders are clearly identified and actively managed from the outset. Understanding who matters—and how—helps reduce risk, improve alignment, and accelerate decision-making.

Professionals skilled in stakeholder mapping can:

- Identify key stakeholders across functions, levels, and geographies
- Understand influence, priorities, and decision-making dynamics
- Segment stakeholders based on impact and engagement needs



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Stakeholder mapping \(3m 4s\)](#)
- [Identify stakeholders \(2m 26s\)](#)
- [Identify and develop relationships with stakeholders \(4m 42\)](#)
- [Identifying key stakeholders \(3m 15s\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Stakeholder grid and coalition planning](#)

02 Building Trust & Relationships

Why is building trust the foundation of effective stakeholder relationships?

Trust is consistently identified as a key driver of collaboration and performance. Without it, alignment slows and resistance increases. With it, teams move faster, communicate openly, and deliver better outcomes.

Professionals who build strong stakeholder relationships can:

- Establish credibility through consistent delivery and follow-through
- Build rapport across diverse roles and perspectives
- Strengthen long-term partnerships



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Building relationships with stakeholders \(4m 32s\)](#)
- [Building Trust \(54m\)](#)
- [Building relationships, earning trust \(3m 4s\)](#)
- [Tips to Build Trust \(13m\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Practice owning a mistake and rebuilding trust](#)
- [Being transparent to build trust with your team](#)
- [Build trust with a new professional connection](#)

03 Influencing Without Authority

Why is influencing without authority a critical skill in modern organizations?

In matrixed and cross-functional environments, influence—not hierarchy—drives outcomes. Professionals who can align stakeholders without direct authority are better equipped to navigate complexity and deliver impact.

Professionals skilled in influencing without authority can:

- Align stakeholders around shared goals and outcomes
- Navigate competing priorities and perspectives
- Build consensus across teams and functions



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Influencing Others \(1h 20\)](#)
- [Leading without Formal Authority \(1h 9m\)](#)
- [Influencing fundamentals \(2m 37s\)](#)
- [Understanding your stakeholder's goals \(2m 31s\)](#)
- [Communicating for influence \(2m19s\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Influence without authority](#)
- [Communicating with impact and influence](#)

04 Managing Expectations & Communication

Why is managing expectations key to stakeholder success?

Misaligned expectations are one of the most common causes of project delays and dissatisfaction. Clear, proactive communication ensures stakeholders stay informed, aligned, and confident throughout delivery.

Professionals who actively listen and seek feedback can:

- Communicate progress, risks, and changes transparently
- Adapt communication styles to different stakeholders
- Maintain alignment and confidence throughout delivery



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Customer Service: Managing Customer Expectations \(21m 8s\)](#)
- [Project Management: Setting and Managing Expectations \(44m 55s\)](#)
- [Nano Tips for Managing Customer Expectations with Richard Moore \(9m 20s\)](#)
- [Stakeholder Management and Communication for Senior Leaders and Executives \(49m 37s\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Defining and communicating clear, measurable expectations](#)